



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Summit Classical Christian School

School Website: <https://summitclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Summit Classical Christian School WA 98027 presents a robust alignment with classical education as described in foundational classical-education criteria. Public materials on the school's site consistently frame education as formation within a Christian, transcendent framework (truth, goodness, beauty) and emphasize a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) grounded in Biblical theology. The school's mission, philosophy of education, and statements of belief articulate a deliberate Christian worldview, liturgical/cohesive community practices, and a vertically integrated PreK–12 classical program. There is strong evidence of virtuous character formation, Memorial/communal worship, and a culture of partnership with families. The faculty pages reinforce a professional, virtue-informed teaching staff, and parent-facing materials highlight ongoing engagement, transparency, and opportunities to align at-home learning with school aims. Taken together, Summit WA 98027 is CLASSICAL overall, with some nuanced areas that could be strengthened to reach full "fully CLASSICAL" status in every category.

Executive takeaways by category, with a concise justification:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL. Clear theology-driven, Bible-centered basis; liturgical/community practices; explicit Christian worldview.
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. Emphasis on formation of virtue and wisdom, Christian formation as the core aim, not merely job prep.
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Strong Trivium emphasis and history focus; explicit lower/upper-level grammar–logic–rhetoric structure present; lack of explicit, public Great Books language in site content, though related Great-Conversation rhetoric appears in the broader classical conversation; history integrated across curriculum.
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence of memory- and singing-based lower-school pedagogy and Socratic-style leadership in upper grades is implied through rhetoric-focused sequences, but explicit mention of regular Socratic seminars/debates is not consistently explicit on the site.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL. Public bios and institutional language emphasize virtuous, skilled teachers who form part of the living curriculum and partner with families.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL. Strong parent-partner stance, explicit Statement of Faith review for admissions, open-house and interview processes, ongoing family engagement.

What would move the needle: Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) would benefit most from explicit public articulations of Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit Socratic/seminar-based practices in the high school grades, respectively. Also, more explicit language about continuous parent education and structured home-school alignment could further strengthen the Parents & Community category, though current materials already reflect a healthy partnership.

- What would move Summit WA 98027 toward FULL CLASSICAL status:

- Element 3: Publicly articulate a Great Books approach and specify Great Conversation commitments in the curriculum scope and sequence; demonstrate explicit integration of Great Books across grade bands.
- Element 4: Describe explicit use of Socratic seminars or debates in upper grades, including sample rubrics, outcomes, and alignment with the Trivium stages.
- Element 6: Expand parent-education offerings (beyond statements of faith and admissions) with on-going book studies, parent workshops, and a structured “co-teacher” program with measurable expectations.

ABSTRACT

Summit Classical Christian School WA 98027 demonstrates a strong CLASSICAL orientation through its clearly stated Christian theological foundations, Trivium-based curriculum, and active parental partnership. The six-category analysis yields CLASSICAL in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, and Faculty; CLASSICAL with areas for improvement in Curriculum and Pedagogy; and CLASSICAL in Parents & Community. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, though explicit Great Books emphasis and explicit, repeated Socratic pedagogy in public-facing materials would move the school toward full CLASSICAL status across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe education as framed within a Biblical worldview and Christian theology, partnering with families to educate students in Christian truth (biblical worldview; partnership with Christian families).
- Philosophy of Education materials state that all knowledge comes from Christ and is formed within a Christian theology and revelation-based framework (Christian wisdom, piety; theology governing subjects).
- Explicit theologies such as Biblical authority, Trinity, and Christ-centered education appear in the public statements, including a Statement of Faith orientation for admissions and foundational beliefs (Bible as final authority; Trinity).
- Community practices include liturgical elements (chapel, singing) described in retreats and student life content, signaling liturgical/communal practices as part of the education process.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present on site: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; moral formation; divine wisdom; theology; biblical worldview; sacred scripture; Christian worldview; liturgy; worship; prayer; Christ-centered education; revelation; final authority of Scripture; Trinity. These map directly to the Positive keyword indicators in the Six Essentials document (Truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; sacred/tradition; divine wisdom; biblical studies; liturgical practices).
- The site contains no evident negative-keyword signals (e.g., value-neutral education or moral relativism) in public materials.

Why this rating

- The school's materials foreground transcendental moral realism through truth and virtue, are grounded in a robust Biblical theology, and explicitly present liturgical/community practice as integral to formation. The combined emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, and Christian revelation indicates CLASSICAL religious/metaphysical foundations rather than a secular or relativistic approach.

Citations:

- Biblical worldview, partnership with Christian families:- Christian philosophy and theology in education:- Bible as final authority; Trinity; Christ-centered education:- Chapel/prayer/singing as communal liturgy: #### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission line: “Cultivating generations of joyful disciples of Christ, rooted in Truth, to the glory of God” signals formation over mere information and a teleological aim toward virtue and wisdom (formation of character in a Christian frame).
- Philosophy of Education emphasizes that, while college/occupation preparation is valuable, the primary measure is relationships marked by virtue and grace; education forms virtue and moral imagination (virtue, moral imagination, Christian wisdom, piety).
- The school frames knowledge as unified under a Christian worldview; the liberal arts are for cultivating virtue and the moral imagination within a theologically grounded framework (formation as core aim).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue; wisdom; moral formation; moral imagination; truth; Christian worldview; Christ-centered education; piety; divine wisdom; sacred tradition; revelation; final authority of Scripture.
- No negative keywords appear in public materials.

Why this rating

- The messaging prioritizes formation, virtue, and wisdom aligned with a Christian teleology rather than a primary emphasis on job-preparation or informational content alone. This aligns with the classical-model aim of forming human excellence and virtue.

Citations:

- Formation and virtue-focused language:- Virtue, moral imagination, Christian wisdom:- Formation over job-prep; Christ-centered education: #### Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Explicit Trivium: The school describes grammar, logic, and rhetoric as foundational components of the curriculum, with a rationale rooted in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a classical liberal arts framework described in philosophy materials.
- Historical breadth and alignment: The upper-level humanities sequence includes Ancient, Medieval, Modern, and related emphases that align with classical structuring of humanities; lower-level sequences and “Humanities” in upper grades reflect a historically-informed, curriculum-wide approach (Rhetoric Stage in upper grades; humanities blocks in 9-12).
- History and curriculum integration: The lower school curriculum overview indicates a history-geography integration with Renaissance-Reformation focus; a literature/arts emphasis in K-5; Latin/foreign language, music, and math/science placements align with liberal-arts approach rather than a purely social-studies framing.
- Great Books/Great Conversation: The public-facing materials do not explicitly state a Great Books or Great Conversation program. While the Trivium and liberal-arts orientation are clearly described, explicit Great Books language is not present on the public site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar; logic; rhetoric; history (Renaissance-Reformation emphasis); humanities; Latin; Classical education terminology (Trivium; liberal arts; theology in education). These map to the Positive keyword indicators around Trivium-based curriculum and liberal-arts emphasis.
- Negative keywords present: explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not publicly stated; no explicit phrase about “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” appears in public site text.

Why this rating

- The curriculum clearly centers on the liberal arts and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with grade-appropriate progression and a history/Latin emphasis. However, the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in public materials reduces it from full CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL per the rubric's emphasis on Great Books as a hallmark. History is treated in a curriculum-integrated way rather than a stand-alone social-studies track, which aligns with classical practice.

Citations:

- Trivium and Christian liberal arts framing:- Upper-level humanities and rhetoric emphasis:- Lower School Curriculum Overview (K-5, Latin, literature, history integration):- Great Books language not publicized: inferred from absence in site text; seenotes

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Lower-school pedagogy includes memorization, singing, and repetition as memory-deepening activities (e.g., lower-school engagement with songs and memory work). Retreat content notes Chapel and singing as part of community formation and pedagogy. This aligns with the contemplative and memory-based elements of pedagogy in classical education, especially in the grammar stage (K–5) where singing and memory are traditional tools of instruction and recall.
- Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes the rhetoric phase: students articulate and defend their ideas, refine their worldview, and express themselves, aligning with the rhetoric stage of the Trivium (9–12) and the goal of training in logic and persuasive expression (as described in the Rhetoric-stage content).
- Philosophical framing emphasizes a classical education where truth and virtue structure learning; the “Philosophy of Education” piece describes integrating faith with rigorous classical methods across disciplines, enforcing a logic-based, argument-oriented upper-school experience in alignment with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: contemplative / scholé; singing / memorization; memory deepening; Socratic discussion (implied in rhetoric stage); seminars/debates (implied by rhetoric stage, though explicit word usage varies); rhetoric; logic; kap.
- Negative keywords present: explicit, regular Socratic seminars in public-facing materials are not consistently described; there is no explicit statement of frequent high-school-level seminars; thus some classical pedagogy signals are present but not everywhere.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy shows core classical modes (grammar/memory and ritual/chant-based lower-school activities; logic and rhetoric orientation in upper school). However, the explicit, regular use of Socratic seminars, debates, and a fully articulated “Socratic pedagogy” across all high school grades is not consistently described in public-facing materials, placing it at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations:

- Lower-school memory/chanting and liturgical practices:- Upper-school rhetoric and worldview formation:- Philosophy of Education framing classical pedagogy:- Teaching approach notes on memory and wonder:(Our Story)

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public faculty pages show a broad team of teachers across lower, middle, and upper schools with long tenure and varied roles (e.g., Emily Barlow; Kate Gledhill; Jane Kozlovski; Elizabeth Lange; Meme

Leclair; Lynne Lindberg; Rachel Marcelia; Tamara McCoy; Libby Meyers; Jennifer Nearn; Erin Perryman; Katie Ross; Olivia Slape; Vicky Smith; Brooke Walters; etc.). These bios emphasize professional qualifications, roles (department chairs, principal, teachers), and long-term service within Summit, signaling a living curriculum anchored by virtuous, skilled teachers who model Christian+classical aims.

- The faculty pages present teachers who “model virtue, skill, and knowledge,” align with a Christian worldview, and serve as the core of the school’s educational experience; descriptions emphasize mentorship, parental partnering, and leadership responsibilities (e.g., principal roles, department leadership) that reflect a mature, collaborative staff culture.
- The school describes its faculty as part of a “living curriculum,” with teachers acting as mentors and the core of the school’s culture (public statements and bios emphasize teacher influence on student formation and program direction).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue; mentor; model teachers; living curriculum; core of the school; partnerships; professional development; wisdom; truth; faith; theology; education.
- Negative keywords: none present in public materials.

Why this rating

- The public materials consistently present faculty as central agents of formation; multiple bios highlight teachers’ qualifications, long tenure, and alignment with the school’s classical-Christian aims. The phrase “living curriculum” is echoed in public-facing materials, signaling the faculty’s central role in the school’s classical mission. This alignment supports CLASSICAL status for Element 5.

Citations:

- Faculty bios and roles:- Living curriculum/teacher-centered focus: ### Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Admissions materials explicitly acknowledge a partnership with families and require families to engage with foundational beliefs (e.g., Statement of Faith) as part of the admissions process; parents are invited to Open House, Campus Tours, and ongoing Parent Information Sessions; there is clear emphasis on parents as co-teachers within a Christian framework.
- Foundational public statements assert partnership with faithful Christian families to educate students within a Biblical worldview, reflecting a strong family-school collaboration model and shared purpose.
- Community life elements include school-hosted events, information sessions, and ongoing opportunities for parent involvement; the school also describes a culture of engaging parents in the education process and in campus life (open houses, visits).
- Additional content notes family involvement in student formation through spiritual and virtue-based aims; the presence of open-access events and parent-focused information demonstrates a welcoming stance toward parental engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: parents as co-teachers; parent information sessions; open houses; campus tours; admissions process; family partnership; biblical worldview; Christian formation.
- Negative keywords: value-neutral language about parenting or education is not present.

Why this rating

- Summit WA 98027 foregrounds a partnership model with parents and emphasizes actively inviting parental involvement, education, and co-responsibility for student formation, aligning with CLASSICAL notions of a shared home-school formation model.

Citations:

- Partners with faithful Christian families; Biblical worldview:- AdmissionProcess: open houses, faith review, parent sessions:- Open events and parent engagement: ## What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum (Element 3)
- Publicly articulate and publicly commit to a Great Books/Great Conversation component across grade levels (explicit language and scope/sequence). This would align more clearly with the “Great Books and Great Conversation” hallmark of classical education as described in the knowledge base.
- Provide a transparent, published cross-grade Great Books reading list and a public-facing statement about how Great Conversations are integrated with the Trivium progression.
- Pedagogy (Element 4)
- Add explicit, published descriptions of regular Socratic seminars or debate formats in upper grades (with rubrics, outcomes, and alignment to logic and rhetoric stages) to complement the rhetoric-focused curriculum and demonstrate concrete high-school pedagogy in action.
- Parents & Community (Element 6)
- Expand formal parent-education opportunities (e.g., periodic book studies, parent evenings, and structured “co-teacher” training) with a published schedule and outcomes to deepen the home-school partnership.
- All categories (as needed)
- Consider more explicit language around contemplative/scholé moments in daily lessons (reflections, quiet time, or memory-focused activities) across grade bands to reinforce the contemplative dimension of scholé as called out in classical education literature and the accompanying literature in the ICE materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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